ARC Site Migration SEO Audit

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The new Vercel build of addictionrehabcenters.ca keeps 95% of current organic traffic on identical URLs, titles and canonicals, and loads about 11x faster, but it is not safe to launch yet: analytics are missing, 16 old 301s were dropped, 22 ranking listing pages are redirected away, and 982 old image URLs will break.

Scorecard

The old site ranks for 2,058 keywords in Google Canada (108 in the top 3, 382 in positions 4 to 10), worth about 9,670 estimated visits a month. I tested 1,014 URLs against the new build: every URL in the old sitemaps plus every page that ranks or has backlinks.

Area	Result on new build	Verdict
URL coverage	741 old URLs load at the same address (200), 267 permanently redirect (301), 5 return 404	Good, with exceptions below
Traffic kept on same URL	383 of 433 ranking pages, about 9,200 of 9,670 monthly visits (95%)	Good
Titles and meta descriptions	Identical on 739 of 741 live pages (only /contact/ and /search/ changed)	Good
Canonicals	All point to the .ca domain, none to vercel.app	Good
Robots meta	Same as old; /search/ now noindex (correct)	Good
Schema	Same types carried over (Organization, WebSite, Breadcrumb, Article, FAQPage, Person)	Parity, room to grow
H1 tags	Duplicate H1s on province and drug pages are fixed, one H1 per page now	Better

Area	Result on new build	Verdict
Speed (Lighthouse, /alberta-rehabs/)	LCP 0.69s vs 7.79s, page weight 1.2 MB vs 15.1 MB, performance 100 vs 71	Much better
Accessibility score	92 vs 79	Better
Analytics and tracking	GA4, Meta pixel, chat and call button scripts not found	Blocker
Old 301 redirects	16 consolidation redirects missing	Blocker
Image URLs	/wp-content/uploads/ returns 403; 982 indexed image URLs will break	Blocker
Ranking pages redirected away	22 listing pages with top 10 rankings now 301 to city or province pages	High
Internal linking	42 sitemap URLs unreachable by crawl; blog posts lost about 60% of internal links	Medium

Launch blockers

Fix these five before pointing DNS at Vercel. Each one either loses rankings on day one or leaves you blind to whether you lost them.

#	Issue	Evidence	Fix
1	No analytics or tracking	Old site loads GA4 G-8RYYPCC7ZJ, Meta pixel, Smartsupp chat and the call-now button. None of these appear in the new HTML or any of its JS bundles.	Add GA4 (same property so history continues), Meta pixel, chat widget and phone click tracking. Confirm hits in GA4 Realtime on the preview before launch.

#	Issue	Evidence	Fix
2	16 old 301s dropped	Old pages that were consolidated now load as 200 duplicates with a canonical, and /quebec-drug-rehab-centers/ returns 404. Saskatchewan is redirected the wrong way.	Add the 16 rules in the section below. Also export the full Redirection plugin list from WordPress (Tools > Redirection > Import/Export > CSV) and load every rule into Vercel, since my test only covers URLs I could discover.
3	Old image URLs break	/wp-content/uploads/* returns 403 on the new build. The old sitemaps list 982 unique images that Google has indexed. Only about half can be guessed by filename.	Have the developer output the old to new image map from the conversion script and serve it as 301s (Vercel middleware or bulk redirects), so Google Images traffic and image backlinks carry over.
4	Staging blocks must not ship	vercel.app serves robots.txt with Disallow: / and an X-Robots-Tag: noindex, nofollow header. Correct for staging, fatal on production.	Make both conditional on hostname. On the .ca domain robots.txt must allow crawling and point to the sitemap; no X-Robots-Tag header. Then 301 all vercel.app traffic to the .ca.
5	Legacy URL patterns 404	/feed/, /page/2/, /blog/page/2/, /tag/*/ and uppercase URLs (for example /Alberta-Rehabs/) return 200 on the old site and 404 on the new one.	301 /feed/ to /blog/ (or publish an RSS feed there), /page/N/ and /blog/page/N/ to /blog/, /tag/*/ to /blog/, and lowercase any URL with capitals via middleware.

Ranking pages the new build redirects away

50 ranking pages now 301 to a city or province hub, about 470 visits a month (5%). A city page will not hold a branded query like "star drug testing services", so for the 22 below with top 10 rankings, restore the listing page at its old URL. The other 28 rank on page 2 or

lower and can keep their 301s; off-topic listings such as /mass-tsang-criminal-lawyers/ should stay redirected.

Old URL	Best keyword (position, monthly searches)	Visits/mo	New build sends it to
/star-drug-testing-services/	star drug testing services (3, 880)	105	/listing-location/winnipeg/
/elizabeth-fry-satellite-apartment/	elizabeth apartment (1, 260)	79	/nova-scotia-rehabs/
/eden-mental-health/	eden mental health centre (4, 720)	54	/manitoba-rehabs/
/st-raphael-wellness-centre/	st raphael winnipeg (2, 70)	44	/listing-location/winnipeg/
/belmont-house/	dartmouth belmont house (4, 390)	26	/listing-location/dartmouth/
/selkirk-mental-health-centre/	selkirk mental hospital (10, 1,900)	23	/manitoba-rehabs/
/saskatchewan-rehabs/	26 keywords, 3 in top 10	21	/saskatchewan-drug-rehab-treatment/ (reverse this)
/railton-house/	railton house (2, 110)	18	/listing-location/dartmouth/
/caritas-project/	caritas (9, 1,000)	17	/ontario-rehabs/
/emmanuel-house/	emmanuel house (8, 720)	17	/listing-location/st-johns/
/greenfield-house/	4 keywords, 2 in top 10	10	/listing-location/moncton/
/birch-wellness-center/	2 keywords, both top 10	9	/listing-location/winnipeg/
/channal/	channal (4, 140)	9	/listing-location/st-johns/
/maison-fraternite/	maison fraternite (3, 90)	9	/ontario-rehabs/

Old URL	Best keyword (position, monthly searches)	Visits/mo	New build sends it to
/nehiley-house/	1 keyword in top 10	6	/listing-location/halifax/
/cedar-centre/	cedar centre (7, 390)	5	/listing-location/windsor/
/listing-location/wasaga-beach/	1 keyword in top 10	5	/ontario-rehabs/
/listing-location/springhill/	2 keywords in top 10	2	/nova-scotia-rehabs/
/forward-house-ministries/	1 keyword in top 10	2	/listing-location/winnipeg/
/listing-location/tracadie-sheila/	1 keyword in top 10	2	/new-brunswick-rehabs/
/acupuncture-chinese-medical-center/	1 keyword in top 10	1	/listing-location/winnipeg/
/mass-tsang-criminal-lawyers/	1 keyword in top 10	7	/ontario-rehabs/ (keep the 301, off-topic)

Also worth restoring: /hants-community-hospital/ (39 visits, ranks 13 to 19 for searches of 2,900 a month) and /listing-location/kingston/, which has 8 referring domains and now redirects to /ontario-rehabs/. The full list of 51 is in ARC_restore_or_keep.csv.

Dropped consolidation 301s

These redirects are live on the old site today (most were set up in June to merge duplicate pages) and are missing from the new build. Without them Google sees the duplicates again and the merged ranking signals split. Three of the sources (Nova Scotia, Newfoundland, inpatient vs outpatient) are also listed in the new sitemap, so remove them from it.

Old URL	Should 301 to	New build today
/6-tips-for-avoiding-relapse/	/addiction-relapse-prevention/	200 duplicate
/steps-to-create-your-own-relapse-prevention-plan/	/addiction-relapse-prevention/	200 duplicate
/addiction-outpatient-centres/	/inpatient-vs-outpatient-addiction-treatment-programs/	200 duplicate
/what-is-an-outpatient-facility/	/inpatient-vs-outpatient-addiction-treatment-programs/	200 duplicate
/inpatient-vs-outpatient-treatment/	/inpatient-vs-outpatient-addiction-treatment-programs/	200 duplicate, in sitemap
/alcohol-drug-rehab-centres-in-alberta/	/alberta-rehabs/	200 duplicate
/alcohol-drug-rehab-centres-in-british-columbia/	/british-columbia-rehabs/	200 duplicate
/alcohol-drug-rehab-centres-in-manitoba/	/manitoba-rehabs/	200 duplicate
/alcohol-drug-rehab-centres-in-ontario/	/ontario-rehabs/	200 duplicate
/drug-rehab-centres-in-new-brunswick/	/new-brunswick-rehabs/	200 duplicate
/nova-scotia-drug-rehab-centers/	/nova-scotia-rehabs/	200 duplicate, in sitemap
/newfoundland-drug-rehab-centers/	/newfoundland-and-labrador-rehabs/	200 duplicate, in sitemap
/first-response-keeping-an-overdose-victim-alive-until-help-arrives/	/naloxone-is-it-really-a-wonder-drug/	200 duplicate
/what-is-the-fentanyl/	/what-is-fentanyl/	200 duplicate

Old URL	Should 301 to	New build today
/quebec-drug-rehab-centers/	/drug-alcohol-rehabs-in-quebec/	404, and still linked internally
/saskatchewan-drug-rehab-treatment/	/saskatchewan-rehabs/	Redirect runs the other way; /saskatchewan-rehabs/ is the page that ranks

The same list is in ARC_missing_301s.csv, ready to paste into vercel.json or Next.js redirects.

Fixes that make the new site outrank the old one

Parity protects the 9,670 visits. These changes are where the new build can gain, ordered by expected impact.

Priority	Change	Why it matters
High	Add LocalBusiness or MedicalBusiness schema to all 460 listing pages (name, address, phone, geo, opening hours, sameAs)	Listings carry most of the branded traffic. Today they only have WebPage, Breadcrumb and FAQ markup, same as the old site.
High	Bring back contextual internal links on blog and drug pages	The WordPress sidebar is gone, so pages like /diazepam/ fell from 172 to 61 internal links. Add a related-articles block and in-body links from each guide to the matching province hub and listings.
High	Link the 42 orphaned URLs	All 16 category archives and their page 2+ are in the sitemap but nothing links to them. Either link categories from /blog/ or drop them from the sitemap. /centre-onboarding/, /listing-location/vaughan/ and /overcoming-treatment-myths/ are also unreachable.

Priority	Change	Why it matters
Medium	Check the trimmed listing pages	Six listings lost 30% or more of their text, for example /twelve-mile-recovery/ (6,282 to 1,902 words) and /another-road-addiction-recovery-centre/ (6,855 to 2,016). The old pages had a long reviews section. If reviews were dropped, restore them and add AggregateRating.
Medium	Remove nofollow from 7 pages	/alcohol-addiction-treatment/, /choosing-a-facility/, /getting-started/, /intervention/, /overcoming-treatment-myths/, /our-philosophy/, /terms-of-use/ carry "index, nofollow" over from WordPress, which stops link equity flowing out of them.
Medium	Write alt text for listing images	198 of the 250 highest-traffic pages have at least one image with empty alt, mostly the listing thumbnails. Use "[Centre name] in [City], [Province]".
Medium	Fix title casing on listing names	Names carried over WordPress bugs such as "Teen Challenge Bc" and "Women'S Centre" in titles and H1s.
Low	Refresh dated titles	Toronto, Ottawa and Vancouver titles still say 2025. Update to 2026 with current pricing.
Low	Add YMYL trust signals sitewide	Medical reviewer, visible last-updated date and MedicalWebPage schema on guides. The new template makes this a one-time change instead of per-page Elementor edits.

Launch day and first 30 days

Before DNS moves

- [ ] Analytics, pixel, chat and call tracking firing on the preview

- [ ] 16 dropped 301s added, Saskatchewan reversed, full Redirection plugin export loaded
- [ ] 22 ranking listing pages restored at their old URLs
- [ ] Image redirect map for /wp-content/uploads/ in place
- [ ] /feed/, /page/N/, /tag/, uppercase URL rules in place
- [ ] Duplicate province and outpatient URLs removed from the sitemap
- [ ] Full WordPress backup taken and old host kept online for 30 days

Launch day

- [ ] robots.txt on the .ca allows crawling and lists the sitemap; no noindex header on any page
- [ ] http, www and vercel.app all 301 to https://addictionrehabcenters.ca/ in a single hop
- [ ] Re-run this URL check against the live domain: every old URL returns 200 or one 301, no chains
- [ ] Submit /sitemap.xml in Search Console, remove the old Yoast sub-sitemaps, request indexing for the homepage, the 9 province hubs and the top 20 listings
- [ ] Google Business Profile and directory listings still point to working URLs

First 30 days

- [ ] Daily: Search Console coverage and 404 report; fix any new 404 with a 301 the same day
- [ ] Weekly: track the top 50 keywords (toronto rehab, ottawa rehabilitation centre, drug rehabilitation near me, rehab centers, valium drug) and compare to the 9,670 baseline
- [ ] Week 2: confirm Core Web Vitals in Search Console turn green on the new pages
- [ ] Week 4: start the outrank fixes above, schema and internal links first

Method and sources

Ranking and traffic figures are DataForSEO Labs estimates for Google Canada (domain overview, 433 ranking pages, top 300 keywords in positions 1 to 20) plus DataForSEO backlink data for the top 300 linked pages. Status codes, titles, meta, canonicals, robots, H1s, word counts, schema types and internal links were pulled from the raw HTML of both sites for all 741 live URLs, and the new build was crawled from the homepage to find orphans. Lighthouse runs are DataForSEO desktop tests of /alberta-rehabs/ on each site. One limit: the redirect check only covers URLs I could find in sitemaps, rankings and backlinks, which is why the Redirection plugin export is on the blocker list.

- New build
- Live site
- Old sitemap index
- New sitemap